

CHAPTER – IX

ADVANTAGES & DISADVANTAGES

9.1 – Advantages

Indian agriculture employs a lot of people 46.1% of the workforce but it only contributes a small part to the country's income about one-fifth. India has done well in food production with a record 357 million tonnes of foodgrains in 2024-25. We are also the producer of rice, milk and other farm products in the world. But there are some problems in the sector like farmers' incomes have not increased much the environment is getting degraded and there are big gaps in productivity.

1. Global Leadership in Production: India is the world's producer of rice, milk, pulses and spices. It is also a leading producer of wheat, sugarcane and horticultural crops. This leadership ensures food security for over 1.4 billion people. Makes India a major player in international agricultural markets.

2. Diverse Agro-Climatic Conditions: India has different types of climates and soil. This allows farmers to grow a variety of crops throughout the year. It also gives them options for farming.

3. Significant Yield Improvements: Over the 30 years yield improvements have driven agricultural growth. This has increased output without requiring land. The use of yielding seeds, better irrigation and farm machinery has improved productivity.

4. Successful Crop Diversification: India has made progress in crop diversification in horticulture. Horticulture accounts for 6 percent of cropped area but contributes nearly 28 percent to agricultural value.

5. Robust Policy Support Framework: The government has established a policy framework. This includes income support schemes like PM-KISAN, digital marketplaces like e-NAM and extensive crop insurance coverage through PM Fasal Bima Yojana.

6. Strong Export Potential and Performance: India has become an agricultural exporter. Agri-exports have crossed \$50 billion in seafood, spices, basmati rice and processed products.

7. Structural Resilience During Global Crises: The agricultural sector has shown resilience during shocks, including the COVID-19 pandemic. Strong domestic demand and supportive government policies have ensured growth.

8. Employment Generation and Rural Livelihoods: Agriculture is the primary source of livelihood for nearly 46 percent of India's workforce. It provides indirect employment to millions of rural households.

9. Technological. Digital Integration: The use of technologies, precision farming tools and soil health cards is transforming traditional farming practices.

10. Food Security and Strategic Buffer Stocks: India has built a food security system supported by substantial buffer stocks of essential commodities.

11. Vibrant Research and Extension Network: The country has a network of agricultural research institutions and universities. These institutions develop crop varieties and farming techniques.

12. Growing Organic and Sustainable Farming Movement: India is witnessing growth in organic farming and natural farming practices. This shift, toward agriculture reduces input costs and improves soil health.

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